Text 1

第 1 段

For thousands of years, donkeys have been critical for propelling human civilizations forward. They've helped pull wheeled vehicles, carry travelers and move goods across the world. But where and when these animals first became intertwined with humans has been a mystery. Now, researchers have used genomes of over 200 donkeys to trace their domestication back to a single event around 7 000 years ago in East Africa—about 3 000 years before humans tamed horses. The team published their findings in the journal Science this month.

直译：数千年来，驴一直是推动人类文明向前发展的关键。它们帮助拉动带轮车辆、载运旅客，并在世界各地搬运货物。但这些动物最初在何时、何地与人类产生密切联系，一直是个谜。如今，研究人员利用两百多头驴的基因组，把它们的驯化追溯到约七千年前东非发生的一次事件，比人类驯服马大约早三千年。研究团队本月在《科学》杂志发表了结果。

第 2 段

"Through their DNA, the animals are telling their history themselves," co-author Samantha Brooks, an equine researcher at the University of Florida, says in a statement. "We usually only get the human's side of history through written accounts, but of course written history does not always record exactly how something happened. Looking at these DNA sequences, we get a biological testimony to the environment these animals lived in and the experiences they survived."

直译：论文共同作者、佛罗里达大学马科动物研究者萨曼莎·布鲁克斯在声明中说："通过 DNA，这些动物正在亲自讲述自己的历史。我们通常只能通过文字记载，得到人类一方的历史；但当然，文字历史并不总是准确记录事情究竟如何发生。观察这些 DNA 序列，我们便能获得一份生物学证词，了解这些动物生活的环境，以及它们经历并挺过的遭遇。"

第 3 段

The researchers examined 207 genomes from modern donkeys living in 31 countries across the globe. They also looked at genomes from 15 wild equids and 31 earlier donkeys that lived between about 4 000 and 100 years ago. The team reconstructed the animals' evolutionary tree and used computer models to pinpoint the domestication event: when herders in Kenya and the Horn of Africa tamed wild asses. They then traced how the animals spread across the rest of the continent into Europe and Asia about 2 500 years later.

直译：研究人员考察了来自全球三十一个国家的二百零七份现代驴基因组。他们还考察了十五头野生马科动物，以及三十一头生活在约四千年前至一百年前之间的早期驴的基因组。研究团队重建了这些动物的进化树，并用计算机模型精确定位驯化事件，即肯尼亚和非洲之角的牧民驯服野驴的过程。随后，他们追踪了这些动物如何扩散到非洲大陆其他地区，并在大约两千五百年后进入欧洲与亚洲。

第 4 段

Though it's still unclear why the original domestication happened, Science News' Freda Kreier reports that the event coincided with the Sahara growing larger and drier. "Donkeys are champions when it comes to carrying stuff and are good at going through deserts," co-author Ludovic Orlando, an evolutionary biologist at Paul Sabatier University in France, tells the publication. Prehistoric humans may have enlisted donkey's help in navigating the expanding Sahara.

直译：虽然最初的驯化为何发生仍不清楚，但《科学新闻》的弗雷达·克里尔报道说，这一事件与撒哈拉沙漠扩大、变得更加干旱的时期相吻合。论文共同作者、法国保罗·萨巴捷大学进化生物学家吕多维克·奥兰多告诉该刊："说到搬运东西，驴是冠军，而且很擅长穿越沙漠。"史前人类可能借助驴的帮助，穿行于不断扩大的撒哈拉沙漠。

第 5 段

Researchers say these findings could help put donkeys in the spotlight. The animals could benefit from more research; Currently, there are no published genomes from donkeys located south of the equator in Africa. But understanding where the animals were first domesticated could guide archaeologists to a narrower region to search for insights about the original tamed donkeys.

直译：研究人员说，这些发现可能帮助驴受到更多关注。更多研究可以使这些动物受益：目前，还没有发表来自非洲赤道以南地区驴的基因组。但是，弄清这些动物最初在哪里被驯化，可以引导考古学家在更小的区域内寻找线索，了解最早被驯服的驴。

第 6 段

Not only does understanding the equines' genetic makeup help reveal their contribution to human history, but it also might improve their management in the future, as climate change alters the planet's environment, write the authors.

直译：作者们写道，理解这些马科动物的遗传构成，不仅有助于揭示它们对人类历史的贡献，而且在气候变化改变地球环境之际，也可能改善未来对它们的管理。

Text 2

第 1 段

There's no business like show business—but in Los Angeles, it feels like there's no business at all.

直译：没有什么行业能像演艺业一样精彩——但在洛杉矶，感觉却像根本没有生意可做。

第 2 段

If that sounds melodramatic, consider this; The Art Directors Guild, a labor union representing about 3 000 film workers, has suspended a training program and issued a statement explaining that "we cannot in good conscience encourage you to pursue our profession while so many of our members remain unemployed." The guild's pessimism is a reaction to Hollywood's decline, which is reaching a critical point for the industry and Southern California.

直译：如果这听起来过于戏剧化，请考虑一下：代表约三千名电影工作者的工会——艺术指导协会——已经暂停了一项培训计划，并发表声明解释说："在我们如此多的会员仍然失业的情况下，我们无法凭良心鼓励你进入这个职业。"该协会的悲观情绪，是对好莱坞衰退的反应；这种衰退对整个行业与南加利福尼亚而言，正到达一个关键节点。

第 3 段

Production has been slipping away from Hollywood since the 1950s, but the effects have never been more apparent than at present. Other regions in the United States, Canada and Europe have steadily increased incentives to attract TV shows and movies, leaving California in the dust. Georgia offers up to 30% in transferable tax credits on film and TV production costs, plus an additional 10% increase on the base tax credit if the project includes a Georgia promotional logo.

直译：自二十世纪五十年代以来，影视制作就一直在逐渐离开好莱坞，但其影响从未像现在这样明显。美国其他地区、加拿大和欧洲不断增加激励措施，吸引电视剧与电影制作，把加州远远甩在后面。佐治亚州对影视制作成本提供最高百分之三十的可转让税收抵免；此外，如果项目包含佐治亚州的宣传标识，还可在基础税收抵免上再增加百分之十。

第 4 段

Even as California lost a huge volume of production to other locations, there was still plenty of film production taking place in Los Angeles before this year. We were kept afloat by "peak TV": the glut of content that was required by the explosion of streaming services.

直译：即使加州的大量制作业务流失到其他地方，今年以前，洛杉矶仍有大量电影制作活动。支撑我们维持下来的，是"电视高峰"：流媒体服务爆炸式增长所需要的大量内容。

第 5 段

But 2022 was the peak of peak TV. Back then platforms such as Netflix, Amazon and Apple TV hemorrhaged billions of dollars to generate content to attract new subscribers, resulting in 633 scripted series being released that year. As the streamers' emphasis changed from subscriber growth to profitability, prices for the services went up and the number of new shows went down to 481 released in 2023, with the number expected to dip into the 300s within a few years.

直译：但二〇二二年已经是电视高峰的最高点。当时，Netflix、亚马逊和 Apple TV 等平台大量花费数十亿美元生产内容，以吸引新订阅用户，结果当年发行了六百三十三部有剧本的系列节目。随着流媒体平台的重点从订阅人数增长转向盈利能力，服务价格上涨，新节目数量却下降：二〇二三年发行了四百八十一部，预计几年内这一数字将降至三百多部。

第 6 段

If productions in Southern California dip below a critical level for too long, the industry's essential talent will drift away along with enormous sums of revenue. Persuading studios to film here would become much more challenging if we couldn't offer a deep bench of local film workers, on-screen talent and local businesses that support the entertainment industry.

直译：如果南加利福尼亚的制作量低于某个临界水平，并持续太久，行业不可或缺的人才就会流失，同时流失的还有巨额收入。如果我们无法提供充足的本地影视工作人员、出镜人才，以及为娱乐业提供支持的当地企业，说服制片公司在这里拍摄就会变得困难得多。

第 7 段

That's why the California Film Commission and its Los Angeles counterpart, Film LA, should act now, before it's too late. Those agencies and other government bodies should dramatically improve incentives to keep our current shows and attract new productions to Los Angeles. Let's go on with the show... and make sure the show doesn't go on without us.

直译：因此，加利福尼亚电影委员会及其洛杉矶对应机构 Film LA，应该趁为时未晚立即行动。这些机构和其他政府部门，应当大幅改善激励措施，把现有节目留在这里，并吸引新的制作项目来到洛杉矶。让演出继续下去吧……而且要确保，演出不会在没有我们的地方继续。

Text 3

第 1 段

The pioneers of wireless saw it as a gift to all the people. Sir John Reith said that it would end "isolation of the spirit" and rejoiced: "It does not matter how many thousands may be listening, there is always enough for others... the genius and the fool, the wealthy and the poor listen simultaneously."

直译：无线电广播的先驱把它看作送给所有人的礼物。约翰·里思爵士说，它将结束"精神上的孤立"，并欣喜地表示："无论有多少成千上万的人正在收听，总有足够的空间容纳其他人……天才与愚人、富人与穷人，都同时收听。"

第 2 段

Between two great wars this technological innovation built a new kind of national consciousness. Opening this week, a book and exhibition curated by Beaty Rubens at the Bodleian in Oxford records how radio changed everyday life from 1922 to 1939. She draws on letters, diaries and fiction, and a 1939 field notebook of verbatim audience research by Winifred Gill.

直译：在两次世界大战之间，这项技术创新建立了一种新的国民共同意识。本周亮相的一本书和一场展览，由比蒂·鲁本斯在牛津大学博德利图书馆策划，记录了广播如何在一九二二年至一九三九年间改变日常生活。她利用了书信、日记、小说，以及温妮弗雷德·吉尔于一九三九年逐字记录听众调查的田野笔记。

第 3 段

There's fun in testimonies of people enjoying the sheer newness. A cartoon mocks a group failing to converse because they're all in headphones. People report that broadcast music made workmen whistle new tunes. A woman says there have been fewer street fights since the arrival of the wireless but also less stopping and "talking on the brush handle".

直译：人们享受这种纯粹新鲜感的证言，读来颇有趣味。一幅漫画嘲笑一群人无法交谈，因为他们都戴着耳机。有人报告说，广播音乐使工人们吹起了新的曲调。一位女士说，自从无线电广播出现后，街头打架变少了，但人们停下来"扶着扫帚柄聊天"的情况也少了。

第 4 段

By and large the wireless was welcome. I loved the man from the Thirties research who found that wireless suddenly offered "a lot of variety... things I thought I'd never be interested in... ice hockey, perhaps". True: for more than 80 pre-digital years, linear speech broadcasting brought the gift of serendipity, random enlivening of a car journey or dull manual task. In my own book about radio I recorded how, on one drive: "I caught up with the news, learnt some 17th-century history, and was startlingly educated by an unpretentious programme on the history of the stethoscope."

直译：总体而言，无线电广播受到欢迎。我很喜欢三十年代调查中的一个男子，他发现广播突然提供了"很多不同的东西……一些我原以为自己绝不会感兴趣的事物……也许是冰球吧"。确实，在数字时代到来之前的八十多年里，按节目顺序播出的有声广播，带来了意外发现的礼物，偶然使一趟车程或一项枯燥的体力任务变得生动。在我自己关于广播的书中，我记录了某次驾车时的经历："我跟上了最新新闻，了解了一些十七世纪历史，又出乎意料地从一档朴实的听诊器历史节目中学到了许多。"

第 5 段

But radio's enriching serendipity is ebbing. With multiple networks and countless podcasts, a smartphone user selects what to hear and when. And while it is wonderful to take a walk with anything in your headphones, infinite choice encourages us to shrink into niche interests and sympathetic beliefs.

直译：但是，广播那种丰富生活的意外发现正在消退。面对多个网络与无数播客，智能手机用户自行选择听什么、何时听。虽然耳机里伴着任意自己想听的内容散步是一件美妙的事，但无限选择却促使我们缩进小众兴趣和与自己相近的信念之中。

第 6 段

A hundred years on from Marconi and Reith, is the art of mere listening endangered? Some will say the audiobook boom revives it, though I suppose you can then worry about the decline of reading. But inventions shape all of us and it is worth noticing when techno-social habits do change, and asking whether to control them a bit or shield the youngest. Whatever we do, innovation will happen. Today we fret about the isolating culture of smartphone-staring and selfie-vanity, but already in 1939 there was that lady regretting how, when all her street got wirelesses, it lost the neighbourly habit of "talking on the brush handle". It's enough to make a person put down the smartphone and go out front with a yard broom.

直译：从马可尼与里思的时代算起，一百年之后，单纯倾听这门艺术是否正受到威胁？有人会说，有声书的繁荣使它重新焕发生机，尽管我想，那时你又可以担心阅读的衰退了。但是，发明塑造着我们所有人；当技术与社会习惯确实发生变化时，值得留意，并追问是否应当稍加控制，或保护年龄最小的人。不论我们做什么，创新都会发生。如今，我们为盯着智能手机和沉迷自拍虚荣所形成的孤立文化而烦恼；但早在一九三九年，就有那位女士遗憾地说，当她整条街都装上收音机后，街坊之间"扶着扫帚柄聊天"的习惯消失了。这足以让人放下智能手机，拿起院子里的扫帚，走到门前去。

Text 4

第 1 段

When Tom Swetnam joined the U.S. Forest Service in the 1970s, his mandate was to "put everything out," he recalled. But when Swetnam enrolled in graduate school at the University of Arizona's Laboratory of Tree-Ring Research, he was surprised to find a record of repeated blazes dating back hundreds of years before European colonists arrived on the continent. Some of the trees he analyzed bore more than 20 fire scars among their rings.

直译：汤姆·斯韦特纳姆回忆说，当他在二十世纪七十年代加入美国林务局时，接到的任务是"把所有火都扑灭"。但当他进入亚利桑那大学树木年轮研究实验室读研究生时，他惊讶地发现，在欧洲殖民者到达这片大陆之前几百年，就已有反复发生火灾的记录。他分析过的一些树木，年轮之间带有二十多处火痕。

第 2 段

The fact that fires happened so often meant they couldn't have been severe enough to kill most trees. Instead, a growing body of research showed that frequent, low-severity fires made many ecosystems healthier. They rid the forest of dead and sick trees, reducing competition and curbing the spread of disease. Because flammable material couldn't build up on the landscape, blazes tended to move slowly and peter out when they reached the footprints of previous burns.

直译：火灾如此频繁发生这一事实，意味着它们不可能严重到杀死大多数树木。相反，越来越多的研究表明，频繁而低烈度的火，会使许多生态系统更加健康。它们清除森林中的死树和病树，减少竞争，并遏制疾病传播。由于易燃材料无法在地表不断堆积，火势往往移动缓慢，在抵达以往燃烧区域时逐渐熄灭。

第 3 段

In 2022, Swetnam and other scientists teamed up to compile a database of fire-scarred trees from across the continent. Their North American tree-ring fire-scar network (NAFSN) provided the basis for a study published last month. In the study, the researchers compared the historical fire cadence with the wildfires recorded over the past few decades, and uncovered a striking shortfall. The NAFSN sites experienced less than a quarter of the number of fires that would have been expected without fire suppression.

直译：二〇二二年，斯韦特纳姆与其他科学家合作，汇编了一个覆盖全大陆、记录带有火痕树木的数据库。他们建立的北美树木年轮火痕网络（NAFSN），为上个月发表的一项研究提供了基础。在该研究中，研究者把历史上的火灾发生频率与过去几十年记录的野火相比较，发现火灾数量存在惊人的不足。NAFSN 各地点实际发生的火灾，不到没有人为灭火时预计发生数量的四分之一。

第 4 段

This deficit is a testament to the effectiveness of modern firefighting, said Kelly Martin, a past president of the International Association of Wildland Fire. Yet the combined consequences of suppression and climate change have eroded humanity's ability to suppress fires, particularly those that ignite under the most dangerous weather conditions. To prevent entire ecosystems from going up in smoke, Martin said, people must bring healthy fire back to places that need it. At Yosemite National Park, Martin oversaw the use of what are known as prescribed burns to make the landscape more resilient. These fires were carefully planned and intentionally ignited during periods when weather kept the blazes easy to control, and helped eliminate some of the fuel that had built up around important park facilities. Research shows that these prescribed burns make subsequent wildfires less severe, even if later fires happen under the most dangerous weather conditions.

直译：国际荒地火灾协会前主席凯莉·马丁说，这种不足证明了现代消防的有效性。然而，长期灭火与气候变化共同带来的后果，已削弱人类扑灭火灾的能力，尤其是那些在最危险天气条件下燃起的火灾。马丁说，为避免整个生态系统化为灰烬，人们必须把有益的火带回需要它的地方。在优胜美地国家公园，马丁监督实施了所谓“计划烧除”，以增强当地生态环境的恢复力。这些火经过精心规划，并在天气有利于控制火势的时段有意点燃，帮助消除公园重要设施周围积聚的一部分可燃物。研究表明，这类计划烧除能够降低随后野火的严重程度，即使后来的火灾发生于最危险的天气条件下，也依然如此。

第 5 段

Yet even as scientists and public officials increasingly agree on the need for more fires in our forests, climate change is making this tactic more challenging, experts said. "It's a double-edged sword because wildfires are getting more severe and larger under climate change and we need this work even more, but then the work gets more challenging," said Susan Prichard, a fire ecologist at the University of Washington.

直译：但专家表示，就在科学家与公职人员越来越认同森林需要更多火的时候，气候变化却使这种策略更难实施。华盛顿大学火灾生态学家苏珊·普里查德说：“这是一把双刃剑，因为在气候变化下，野火变得更严重、规模更大，我们也就更加需要这项工作，但随后这项工作却又变得更难。”